



TIPS & TRICKS

Record whatever you do in the terminal

Have you ever felt that you should record everything you do in the terminal in a file?

Then try out the following tip. There is a command named *script* which can be used with option *-a* to append the output to a file.

Given below is an example that will show how it works:

```
Mandriva:~$ script -a lfy
Script started, file is lfy
Mandriva:~$ uname -a
Linux localhost.localdomain 2.6.33.5-desktop-2mmb #1 SMP Thu
Jun 17 21:30:10 UTC 2010 i686 i686 i386 GNU/Linux
Mandriva:~$ uname
Linux
Mandriva:~$ exit
exit
Script done, file is lfy
```

Here, the name of the file is *lfy*. You can verify it later by using the code given below:

```
Mandriva:~$ cat lfy
Script started on Mon 16 May 2011 02:09:47 AM EDT
Mandriva:~$ uname -a
Linux localhost.localdomain 2.6.33.5-desktop-2mmb #1 SMP Thu
Jun 17 21:30:10 UTC 2010 i686 i686 i386 GNU/Linux
Mandriva:~$ uname
Linux
Mandriva:~$ exit
exit

Script done on Mon 16 May 2011 02:10:32 AM EDT
```

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Wonders of VIM

VIM has a very useful command set. Here are a few commands that can be used to increase your productivity.

VIM as a file comparator:

Use *-d* switch to compare two files in VIM. This command splits the VIM screen vertically and shows the differences.

```
vim -d file1 file2
```

To load new files in separate windows:

If you have a file named *'first.txt'* loaded already in VIM, then use *'split second.txt'* to load another file named *'second.txt'* in a separate window—IM will split the screen horizontally and load the second file. You can use *'vsplit'* to split the screen vertically. *'Ctrl+w'* can be used to switch between the windows.

VIM as a command:

Normally, we use VIM as an editor; however, it can be used as a command. It allows the execution of VIM commands with switch *'-c'*, for example. Here is a command to replace all *'>'* characters to *'>>'* in a file *FILE.TXT* without opening VIM.

```
vim -c ":s/>/>>/g" -c ":wq" FILE.TXT
```

To open a file in read-only mode:

Use the *'-R'* switch to open a file in read-only mode; later on, *!'* can be used to forcefully write to the file.

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Check your processor and OS architecture

You might want to install a 64-bit OS on your machine, but the processor might just be 32-bit compatible. Sometimes it happens the other way too, i.e., you install a 32-bit OS on a machine that has a 64-bit processor. Here is how to find out whether the installed OS as well as the CPU are of 64-bit or 32-bit.

Given below is the command that will output the details of the OS installed:

```
$ uname -m
```

The result for a 64-bit OS installation (for x86_64 architecture):